

2026

Organizational Profile

Barkat Educational Foundation



Developed by:

Barkat Educational Foundation (BEF)

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From Education to Empowerment!

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1 Barkat Educational Foundation's Information

Name	Barkat Educational Foundation (BEF)		
Address	Kandahar city, Afghanistan		
Country	Afghanistan		
# of legal registration	1889		
Line Department	Ministry of Education		
Facebook	https://www.facebook.com/share/15NaN5snf1/		
WhatsApp	+ 93700054269	Tel	+ 93704008588
Office Email address	Barkatfoundation321@gmail.com		
Contact Person	Mr.Osman Barkat- Founder & Executive Director		
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2 Introduction

Barkat Educational Foundation (BEF) is a national-level, non-political, nonprofit humanitarian organization established on December 14, 2024, in Kandahar, Afghanistan. BEF was founded to provide free, high-quality online education for Afghan girls who lack physical access to schools, believing that educating girls is essential for the progress of society. With a strong team of female staff, BEF delivers diverse short and long-term courses including languages, digital literacy, natural sciences, personal development, and income-generating skills such as freelancing and online trading while respecting Afghanistan's national and cultural values. Beyond education, BEF is committed to advancing protection, health, capacity building, food security, livelihood support, and emergency response, ensuring Afghan girls/women to gain the knowledge, resilience and opportunities needed for a brighter future.

2.1 Vision

To empower Afghan women and communities through equitable access to education, protection, health and livelihood opportunities. We strive to foster a generation of confident, informed, and resilient leaders who can drive progress and reform in society. By breaking barriers of inequality and deprivation, BEF envisions a future where women play a vital role in building safer, stronger, and more sustainable communities.

2.2 Mission

Barkat Educational Foundation (BEF) empowers Afghan women and communities by providing accessible, high-quality education and essential support services. Beyond online learning, BEF addresses protection, health, food security, livelihood, and emergency response needs. Through diverse live courses and practical programs, we equip Afghan women and communities with skills, knowledge, and resilience. Our mission is to break barriers of inequality and enable brighter, safer, and more sustainable futures.

2.3 Goals

to increase equitable access to quality education and essential support services for thousands of Afghan women/girls over the next three years. By enhancing online resources, fostering community engagement, and expanding into protection, health, food security, livelihood, and emergency response, BEF seeks to empower Afghan women and strengthen communities.

2.4 Specific Objectives

- Expand digital platforms to provide easy access to education, health, and livelihood resources for Afghan women and girls.
- Deliver technical and logistical support to female students in remote areas, ensuring full participation in online and community-based programs.
- Offer continuous learning and capacity-building programs across education, personal development, health, and income-generating skills.

- Raise awareness through campaigns highlighting the importance of women's education, protection, and well-being.
- Engage local leaders and influencers to promote and support initiatives that empower Afghan women.
- Conduct community outreach to educate families on the value of girls' education and women's participation in society.
- Collaborate with local and international organizations to host events celebrating women's achievements and fostering partnerships.
- Organize forums and dialogues to address challenges in education, protection, Food security and livelihood, encouraging collective action and solutions.

3. Core Values

1. Education for All

Commitment to providing accessible, inclusive, and quality education for all Afghan girls and women, regardless of restrictions or circumstances.

2. Empowerment

Enabling women and girls to gain confidence, skills, and opportunities to shape their futures and contribute meaningfully to society.

3. Equity and Inclusion

Promoting gender equality and ensuring that marginalized groups, including returnees and IDPs, are not left behind.

4. Community Trust

Building strong relationships with families, communities, and local stakeholders through transparency, accountability and respect.

5. Innovation

Leveraging digital platforms, modern curriculum and creative solutions to overcome barriers to education and humanitarian support.

6. Collaboration

Partnering with national and international organizations, UN agencies, and governmental authorities to maximize impact.

7. Resilience

Supporting Afghan women and girls in developing life skills, livelihoods and coping mechanisms to thrive despite adversity.

8. Humanitarian Service

Extending beyond education to provide protection, food security, emergency response, and psychosocial support for vulnerable women.

9. Sustainability

Ensuring long-term impact through capacity building, volunteer networks and institutional partnerships.

4 Major working areas

In response to the challenging conditions where in-person education is largely inaccessible to girls/women across Afghanistan, Barkat Educational Foundation (BEF) is committed to providing accessible online learning and essential humanitarian support tailored to the needs of vulnerable women and communities. Our core focus is to empower Afghan women including returnees, IDPs, Persons with disabilities and all marginalized groups through education, protection, health, livelihood, and resilience-building programs.

4.1 Educational Programs

- **Multilingual Language Learning and Translation**
Courses in English, German, Arabic, Chinese, Urdu, Turkish and other languages to enhance communication skills and open global opportunities.
- **Computer Studies**
Foundational and advanced digital literacy courses to equip learners with essential technology skills.
- **AI and Emerging Technologies**
Introductory and advanced courses on AI, machine learning, data analysis, and modern digital tools to prepare learners for future opportunities.
- **Graphic Design and Multimedia**
Training in creative design, branding, and multimedia production for professional and income-generating opportunities.
- **Mathematics and Natural Sciences**
Courses to strengthen problem-solving abilities and scientific understanding.
- **Soft Skills and Capacity Building**
Programs in academic writing, public speaking, digital marketing, project management, leadership, and effective communication.
- **Freelancing Skills Development**
Training on independent online work and income generation through global platforms.
- **Online Trading and E-Commerce**
Practical courses on digital marketplaces, entrepreneurship, and business fundamentals.

4.2 Humanitarian and Development Programs

- **Protection and Psychosocial Support**
Initiatives to safeguard vulnerable women, returnees, IDPs, and persons with disabilities while promoting mental health and resilience.
- **Health and Well-Being**
Awareness programs and training to improve community health practices.

- **Food Security and Nutrition**

Support projects to strengthen household food security and promote healthy living.

- **Livelihood and Economic Empowerment**

Skills development and opportunities to enhance self-reliance and income generation for marginalized groups.

- **Emergency Response**

Rapid assistance programs to support communities during crises and natural disasters.

5 Scope of work

Barkat Educational Foundation (BEF) operates with a clear mission to bridge the educational and humanitarian gaps faced by Afghan women, girls, returnees, IDPs, PWDs and all marginalized groups. In contexts where access to in-person learning and essential services is restricted or denied, BEF provides innovative online education and community-based support to empower beneficiaries with knowledge, skills and resilience.

5.1 Operational Approach

- **Outreach and Enrollment**

BEF announces newly established classes and programs through social media platforms and printed materials distributed across cities. Interested participants register via online forms, after which the BEF team verifies data through phone or WhatsApp to ensure inclusivity and accessibility.

- **Digital Learning Platforms**

Once admitted, students join classes through platforms such as Google Meet, engaging in diverse high-quality courses including language learning, computer literacy, AI and emerging technologies, graphic design, mathematics, freelancing, and e-commerce.

- **Inclusive Programming**

Special attention is given to vulnerable groups — including returnees, IDPs, marginalized communities, and persons with disabilities — ensuring they receive tailored support and equal opportunities to participate.

- **Holistic Support**

Beyond education, BEF integrates protection, psychosocial support, health awareness, food security, Capacity building, livelihood training, and emergency response programs to address the broader needs of Afghan communities.

- **Sustainability and Empowerment**

By combining academic learning with practical skills and humanitarian assistance, BEF fosters long-term self-reliance, economic participation, and community resilience.

6 Partnerships and collaborations

Barkat Educational Foundation (BEF) has steadily expanded its network of collaborations to strengthen opportunities for Afghan women and girls.

- **Partnership with K12 international schools**

In 2025, BEF signed MoU with K12 International Schools, enabling us to refer female students for online international schooling programs. Several Afghan girls have already referred, enrolled and are now regularly participating and learning through this platform.

- **Partnership with Afghan Thrive Organization**

BEF has joined the administrative team of Afghan Thrive Organization, through which we refer hundreds of Afghan girls and students to the Coursera international digital learning platform. As a result, many students have successfully completed courses in accounting, psychology, languages, artificial intelligence (AI), effective communication, cybersecurity, project management, mental health, strategic planning, leadership, and more.

- **Partnership with UNHCR Afghanistan**

With the support and partnership of UNHCR Afghanistan, BEF implemented a community-led initiative that trained 500 Afghan women and girls in key protection thematic topics such as Gender-Based Violence (GBV), Psychosocial Support (PSS), Mental Health and Psychosocial Support (MHPSS), and Case Management. Through our female protection mobilizers, we also identified hundreds of cases requiring protection assistance and referred to UNHCR for immediate attention.

- **Female-Led Protection Network**

Supported by UNHCR, BEF has formed a broader female-led network dedicated to protection and safeguarding Afghan women including returnees, IDPs and most vulnerable host communities facing risks, ensuring stronger community-based protection and advocacy.

- **Community and Social Engagement**

Beyond formal partnerships, BEF continues to cultivate a collaborative network of community representatives, social and human rights activists, journalists and youth leaders. Their constructive feedback and active involvement contribute significantly to the ongoing enhancement of BEF's services and initiatives.

7 Geographical coverage

The Barkat Educational Foundation (BEF) specifically caters to Afghan girls and women who are deprived of in-person education due to restrictive policies. In response to this crisis, BEF offers online education and e-learning opportunities across the entire country, providing a vital platform for learning that transcends geographical barriers.

Since its establishment, BEF has reached students from the southern, central, northern, eastern, and southeastern provinces of Afghanistan, enabling thousands of girls and women to access quality education and humanitarian support. While the majority of students initially joined from southern provinces such as Kandahar, Helmand, Uruzgan and Zabul areas hardest hit by restrictions. BEF's programs now extend widely across the nation.

To strengthen its presence, BEF has formally selected provincial representatives in Kandahar, Helmand, Zabul, Uruzgan, Nimroz, Farah, Herat, Kabul, Balkh, Badakhshan, Paktia, Paktika,

Logar, Khost, Ghazni, Nangarhar, Laghman and Kunar provinces. These representatives lead BEF's provincial programs, including psychosocial support (PSS), health, capacity building, food security, and community events, ensuring that services are tailored to local needs and contexts. Through its expansive reach and inclusive operational model, BEF continues to make a significant impact in the lives of Afghan women/girls empowering them to pursue education, protection and livelihood opportunities despite the challenging circumstances they face.

8 Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning Framework

Barkat Educational Foundation (BEF) has established a results-based Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning (MEAL) framework to ensure the effectiveness, inclusivity and sustainability of its educational and humanitarian initiatives. This framework enables BEF to measure impact, adapt programs and maintain transparency with all stakeholders.

Monitoring

Monitoring is carried out as a continuous process, tracking the real-time progress of BEF's diverse programs in education, protection, health, livelihood, food security, and emergency response. Data is regularly collected on student engagement, attendance, participation and course completion, while digital tools record login frequency, session attendance, and interaction with online platforms. In addition, provincial representatives provide field monitoring of outreach activities, community events, and protection initiatives. This dual approach allows BEF to quickly identify challenges faced by Afghan women/girls, ensuring timely adjustments so that every participant has the opportunity to succeed.

Evaluation

Evaluation focuses on assessing both short-term achievements and long-term outcomes. Formative evaluations are conducted during program implementation to refine delivery methods, while summative evaluations at the end of each cycle measure improvements in knowledge, skills, psychosocial well-being, and livelihood opportunities. Pre- and post-assessments track academic progress and capacity development, while longitudinal evaluations help BEF understand the lasting impact of its interventions on education, career prospects, resilience, and community empowerment. Evidence generated through these evaluations guides program refinement and strengthens accountability to supporters and partners

Accountability

Accountability remains a cornerstone of BEF's work. The foundation ensures clear communication of goals, outcomes, and resource use to students, parents, teachers, community members, and partners. Feedback mechanisms such as surveys, interviews, and community forums are regularly implemented to capture stakeholder perspectives. Transparent reporting to partners, including K12 International Schools, Afghan Thrive Organization and UNHCR, reinforces trust and collaboration. By encouraging active participation and safeguarding vulnerable groups, BEF ensures its programs remain aligned with community needs and cultural values.

Learning

Learning is integral to BEF's organizational culture. Insights gathered through monitoring and evaluation are used to refine curricula, enhance instructional methods, and optimize digital platforms. Staff, teachers, provincial representatives, and partners engage in regular reflection

and knowledge-sharing sessions to identify best practices and innovative approaches. BEF also integrates emerging fields such as AI and digital technologies into its programs, ensuring that beneficiaries are prepared for future opportunities. By fostering adaptability and innovation, BEF remains proactive in addressing challenges and continuously improving its services to maximize impact for Afghan women and communities.

9 Impacts and Achievements of BEF

Since its establishment, the Barkat Educational Foundation (BEF) has had a profound and enduring impact on Afghan women and girls, as demonstrated by both quantitative and qualitative outcomes of its programs. Through its innovative online learning platform and humanitarian initiatives, BEF has made remarkable strides in overcoming barriers to education and creating opportunities for empowerment, resilience and self-reliance.

1. Enrollment of Over 1,500 Female Students

Within the first year of operation (December 2024 to December 2025), BEF successfully enrolled more than 1,500 female students from across Afghanistan into various courses, reflecting the high demand for accessible education.

2. Active Engagement of 600 Female Students

Currently, over 600 female students who are banned from attending physical schools are actively engaged in BEF's digital learning programs.

3. Graduation of 180 Female Students

More than 180 female students have graduated from different courses, marking significant milestones in their educational journeys.

4. High Satisfaction and Positive Feedback

BEF has achieved a 95% rate of positive feedback and satisfaction from students and their families, demonstrating trust in the quality and impact of its programs.

5. Establishment of an Inclusive Female Volunteer Network

An inclusive female volunteer network has been established across all Afghanistan, strengthening community engagement and outreach.

6. Creation of Small/Part-Time Jobs

BEF has created small and part-time jobs for 40 female instructors through its digital platforms, contributing to local economic empowerment.

7. International Higher Studies Advising

Five international higher studies advising sessions have been conducted, providing guidance and information to hundreds of university-banned female students seeking opportunities abroad.

8. Protection Training for Female Volunteers

With the support of UNHCR Afghanistan, BEF trained 500 youth female volunteers in key protection thematic areas, including Gender-Based Violence (GBV), Psychosocial Support (PSS), Mental Health and Psychosocial Support (MHPSS), and Case Management.

9. Formal Partnership with K12 International Schools

BEF signed an MoU with K12 International Schools, enabling the referral of female students for international online schooling programs. Several Afghan girls are now regularly participating in these programs.

10. Referral of Students to Coursera

Through collaboration with Afghan Thrive Organization, BEF referred 384 female students to Coursera, where they successfully completed courses in accounting, psychology, languages, artificial intelligence, effective communication, cybersecurity, project management, mental health, strategic planning, leadership, and more.

11. Broader Social and Cultural Impact

BEF's programs have contributed to shifting social perceptions about the role of women in society, encouraging more families to support girls' education and fostering a broader societal shift toward gender equality and women's empowerment.

12. Community Trust and Sustainability

The foundation has earned the trust and support of local communities, particularly parents and families of the students. This trust is essential for the long-term sustainability of BEF's programs and reinforces its reputation as a reliable and impactful organization.

9.1 Success Story: Sayeda's Journey with BEF

Sayeda, a female student of BEF, lives in Nowzad, a remote district in the northern part of Helmand province. Nowzad is located nearly 90 kilometers from the provincial capital Lashkarga and the trip there takes about five hours due to the rough and challenging roads. Residing in the heart of Nowzad, Sayeda is thrilled to be part of BEF. She shares, "Learning English and computers was once just a dream for me. In an environment where girls face numerous restrictions, having the chance to study through BEF is truly a remarkable and rare privilege."

Before enrolling in BEF's program, Sayeda struggled with reading English sentences. Now, she proudly says, "I can now read English sentences, and I am even able to introduce myself in English. This accomplishment means a lot to me."

She recognizes the value of the skills she's gaining, particularly in English and computer literacy. "These skills are incredibly important for improving and expanding my knowledge," she explains. "Now, I can search for information online in English, which allows me to access a wide range of valuable resources that I never had before."

Sayeda is deeply grateful to BEF for the opportunity to pursue her education, saying, "I am extremely thankful to the Barkat Educational Foundation for offering me this life-changing chance. I hope that in the future, we will have more opportunities to participate in different educational programs with BEF."

She ends with sincere appreciation, saying, "To everyone who has supported us, you are our heroes!"

10 BEF Organizational structure



11 Funding Sources

At present, the Barkat Educational Foundation (BEF) does not have any institutional donors to support its operations. The foundation is in urgent need of securing institutional funding to ensure sustainability and growth. With a dedicated and reliable budget, BEF would be able to significantly expand its activities, strengthen its humanitarian and educational services, and provide more comprehensive support to Afghan girls and women who are in dire need of support and empowerment.

Currently, BEF's operations are primarily sustained through private contributions from its Board of Directors and the voluntary efforts of female volunteers. Their generous support has been invaluable in keeping the foundation active and impactful. However, these contributions remain limited and cannot fully meet the growing needs of the organization. As a result, BEF continues to face significant financial constraints that hinder its ability to scale programs and respond comprehensively to the challenges faced by Afghan girls and women.

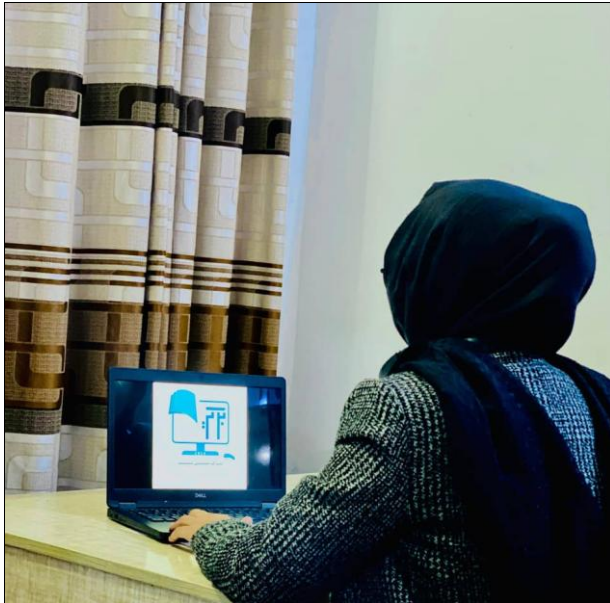
The foundation's monthly budget currently amounts to 70,000 AF, which, while helpful, is insufficient to cover the full scope of operations. Despite these limitations, BEF has achieved remarkable impacts, enrolling more than 1,500 female students, creating jobs for female instructors, and building partnerships with international organizations. However, to maintain and expand these achievements, BEF urgently requires more substantial and reliable financial support. Institutional funding would allow BEF to strengthen its educational programs, expand protection and livelihood initiatives, and ensure long-term sustainability. By investing in BEF, donors and partners would be directly contributing to the empowerment of Afghan girls and women, enabling them to access quality education, build resilience and participate meaningfully in society.

12 Future Outlook for BEF

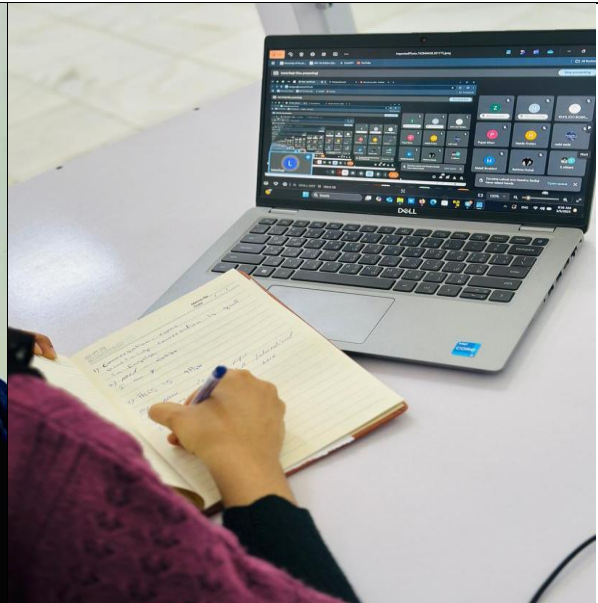
Barkat Educational Foundation (BEF) envisions a future where Afghan girls and women can access quality education, protection, food security and livelihood opportunities despite the challenges they face. Building on its achievements, BEF has outlined the following priorities for the future:

- Establishing online schooling programs up to the 12th grade for Afghan girls.
- Expanding vocational trainings, short-term and long-term life skills and capacity-building programs.
- Developing new courses, including innovative and digital learning opportunities.
- Strengthening community engagement and support to ensure inclusivity and local ownership.
- Enhancing MEAL framework for continuous improvement.
- Continuing coordination with governmental authorities to create new pathways for female support opportunities.
- Empowering the BEF volunteer network to conduct humanitarian activities nationwide.
- Building partnerships with international organizations to expand opportunities.
- Proposing humanitarian projects in collaboration with UN agencies to support Afghan women/girls.
- Facilitating higher education opportunities abroad for Afghan women.
- Supporting livelihood, food security and emergency response for vulnerable Afghan women, including returnees and IDPs.
- Expanding income-generating and life skills courses to promote resilience and economic independence.

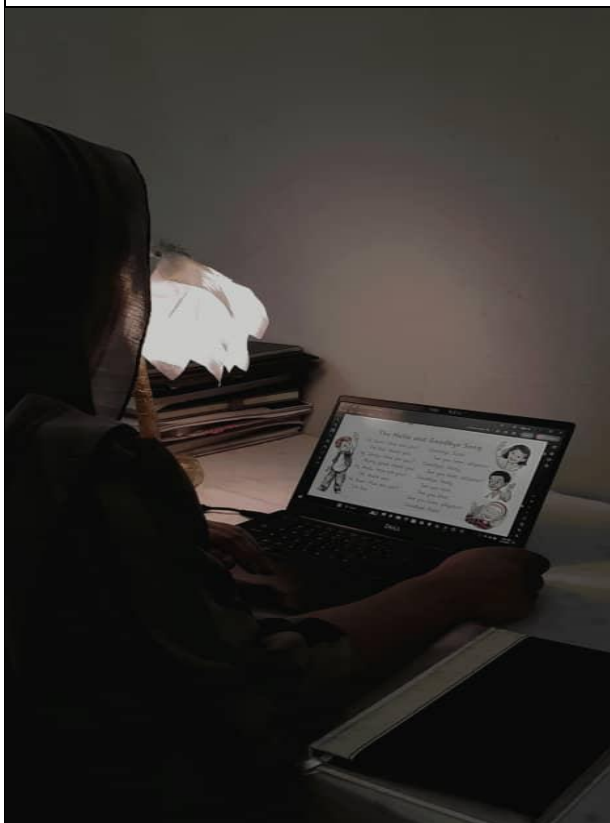
13 Photos of BEF's activities



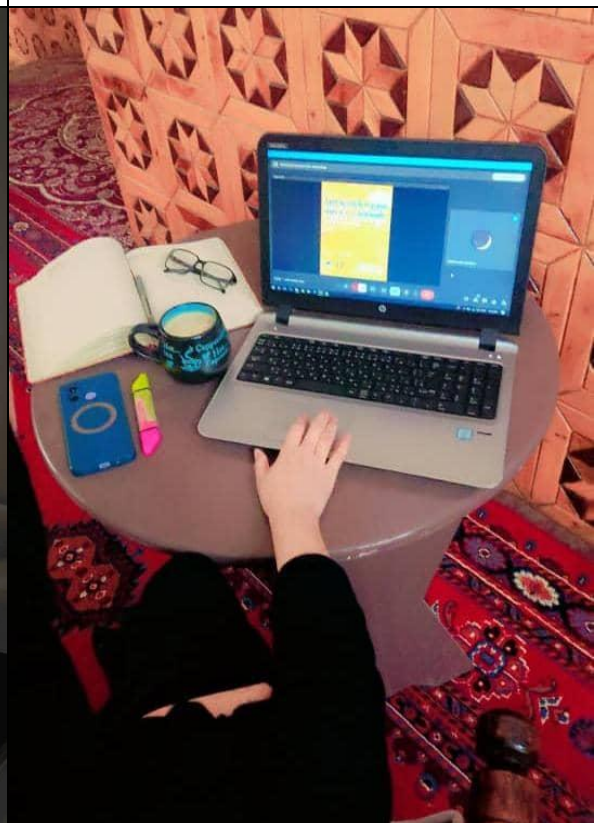
BEF Teacher during online teaching



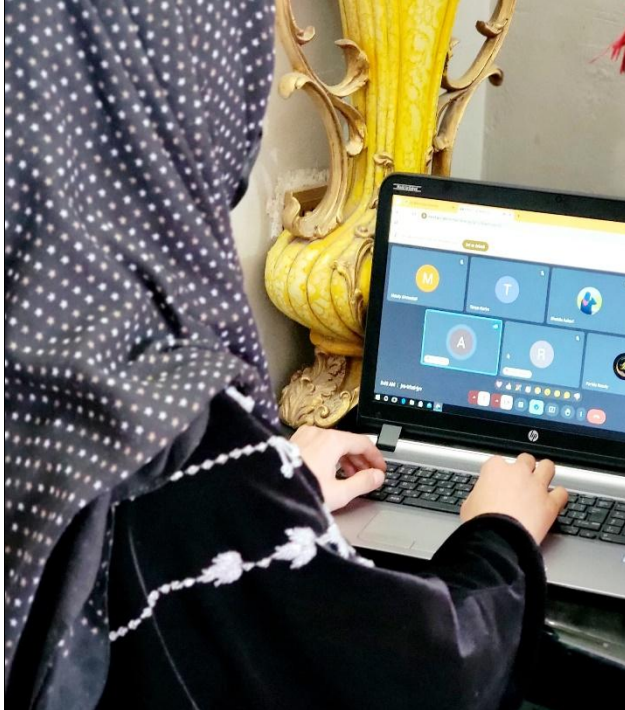
BEF Teacher during online teaching



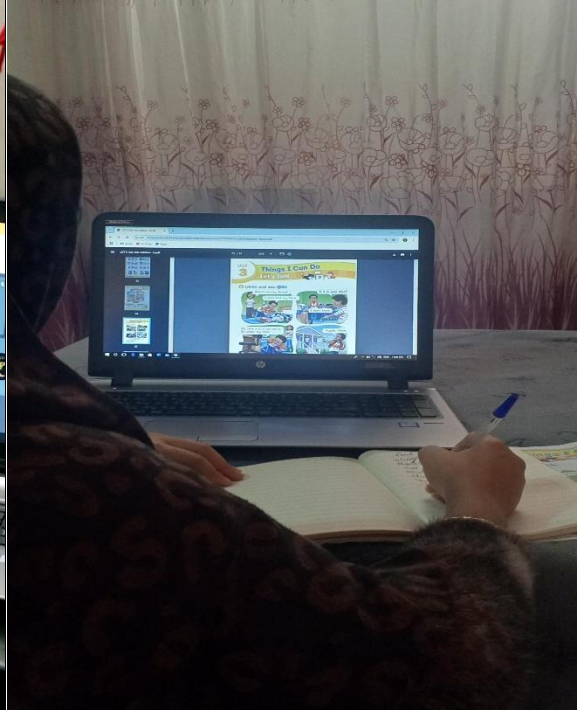
BEF Teacher during online teaching



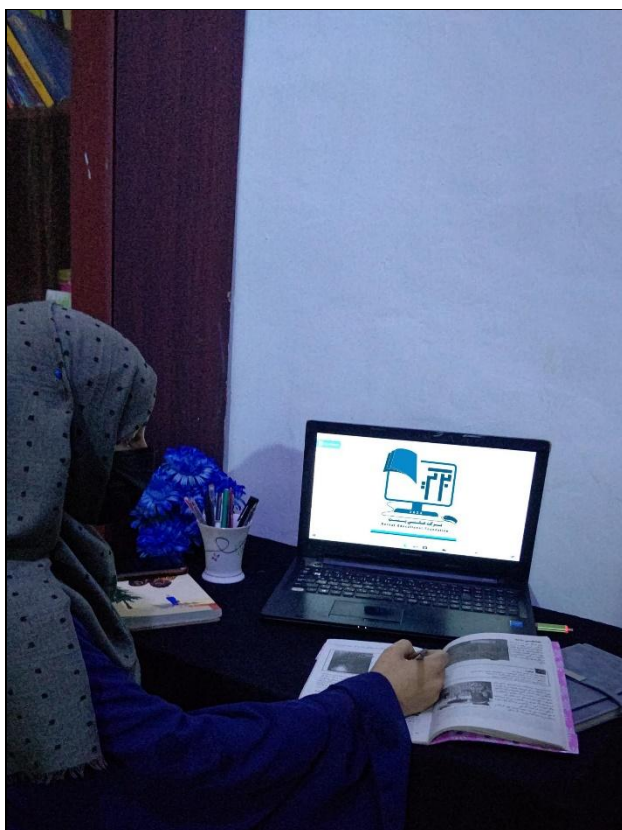
BEF Teacher during online teaching



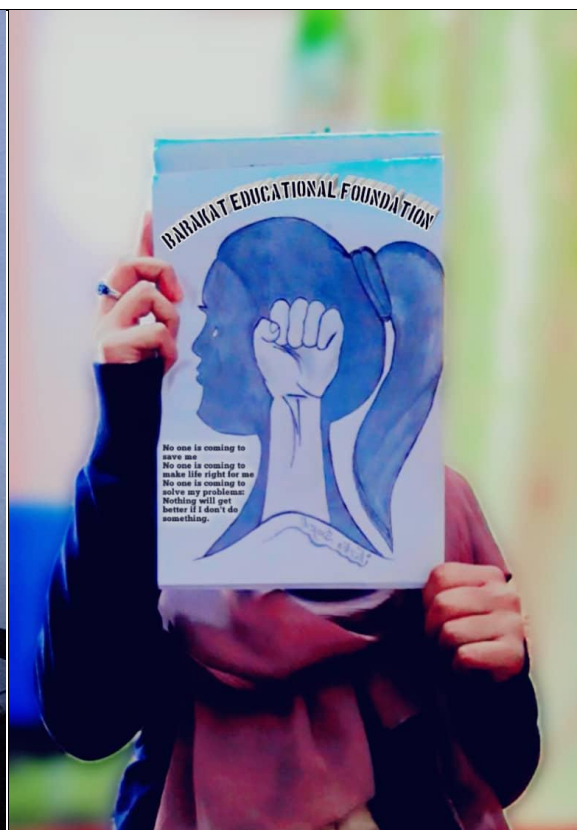
BEF Teacher during online teaching



BEF Teacher during online teaching



BEF student during English learning online course



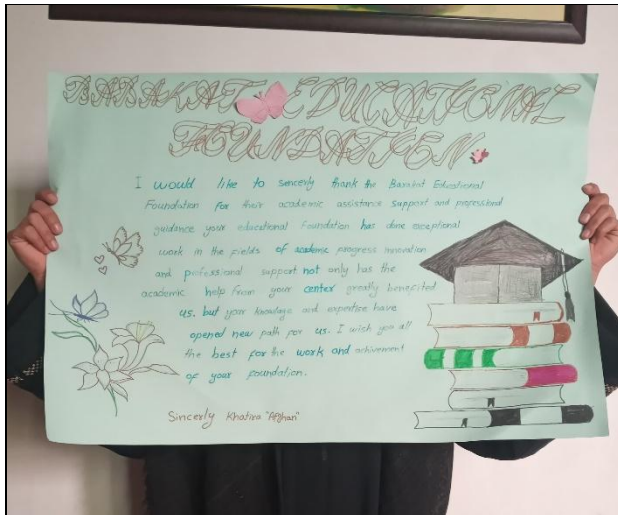
assignment of the students



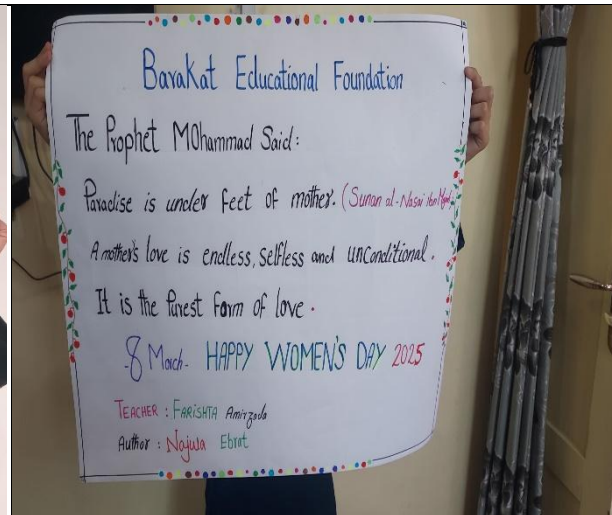
student assignments for international women day



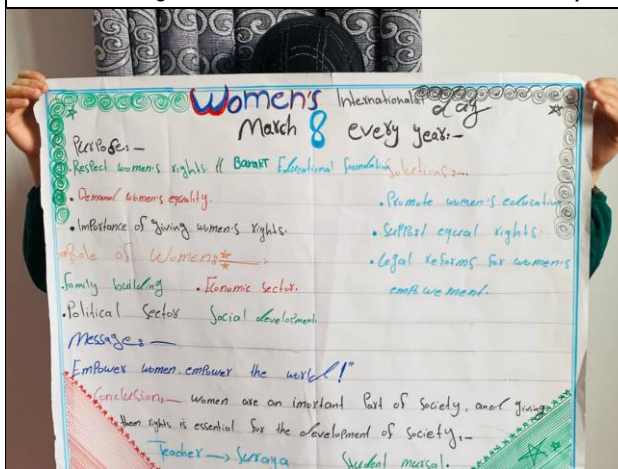
student assignments for international women day



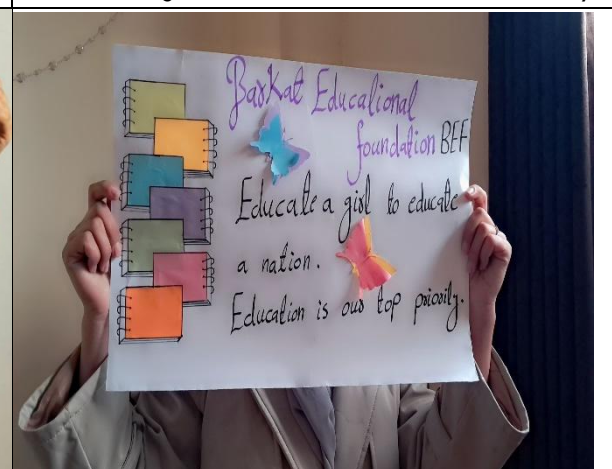
student assignments for international women day



student assignments for international women day



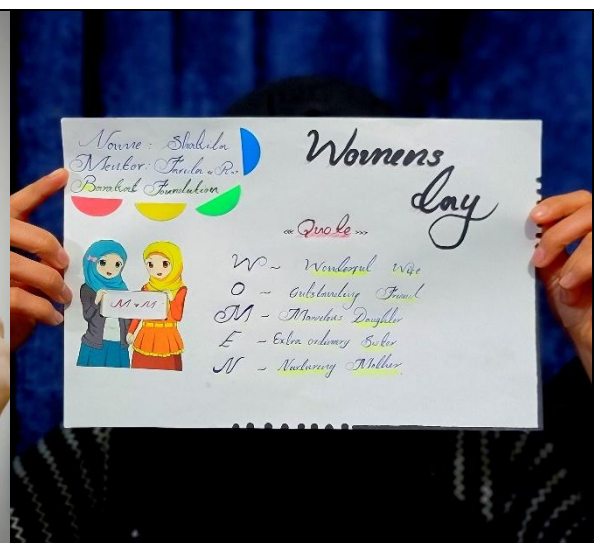
student assignments for international women day



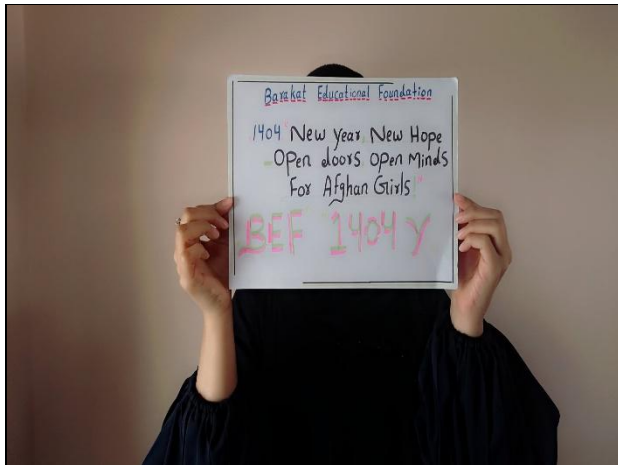
student assignments for international women day



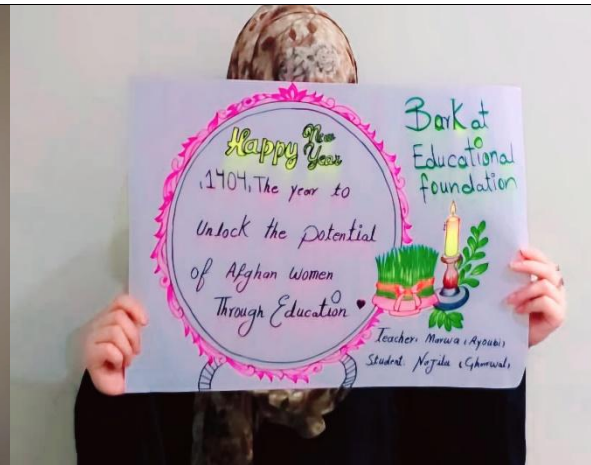
class assignment of a student



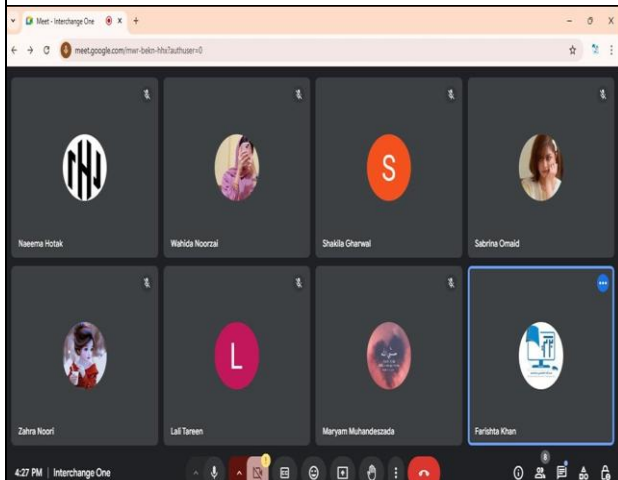
student assignments for international women day



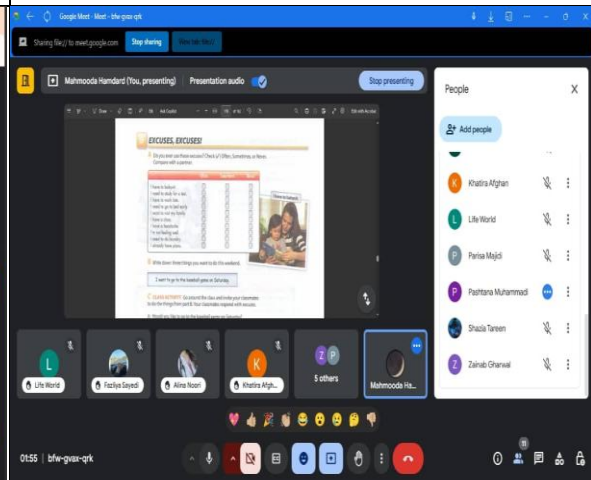
message of a student for new year



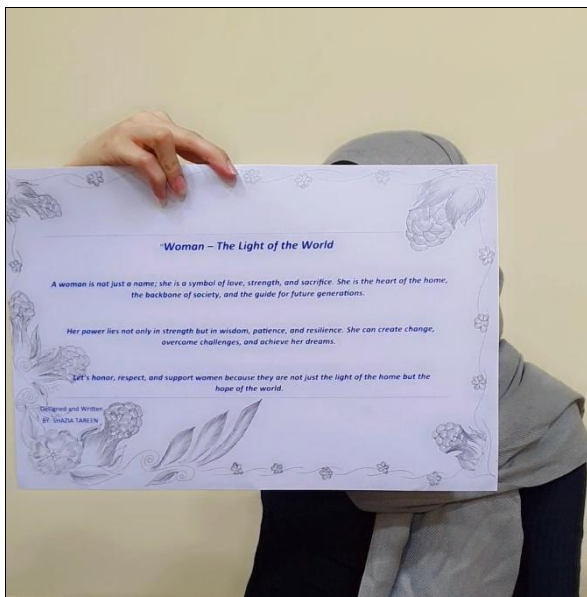
message of a student for new year



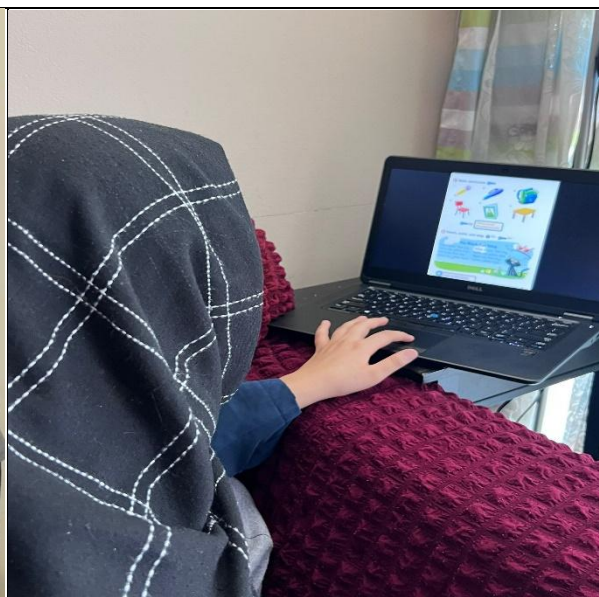
attending class at online platform Google meet



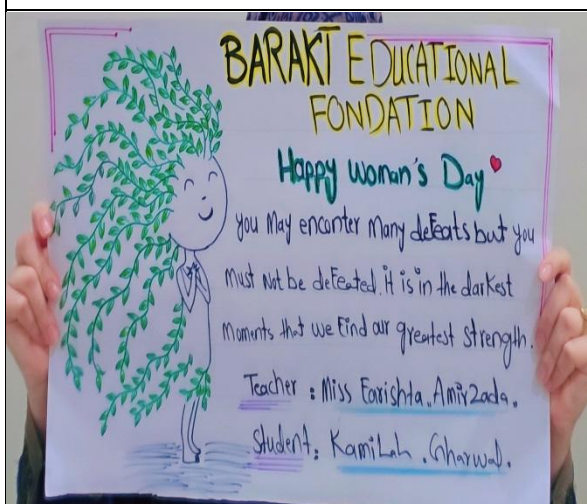
attending class at online platform Google meet



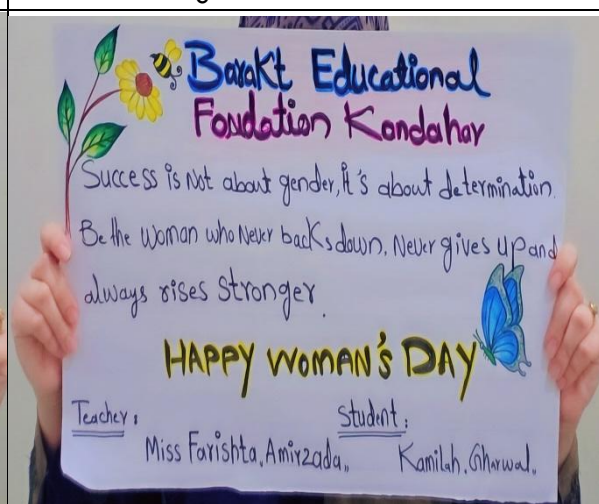
message of student for international women day



a student during her online class



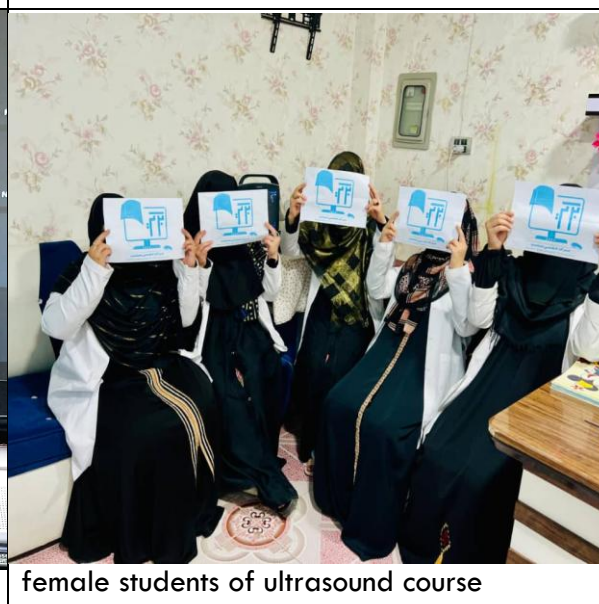
message of student for international women day



message of student for international women day



during celebration of 8th March



female students of ultrasound course